Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez

Ph.D. Candidate in Applied Economics

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Regional and Urban Economics; Public Policy and Program Evaluation; Labor Economics; Economics of Education

EDUCATION

University of Minnesota–Twin Cities — **Saint Paul, MN**
Ph.D. Candidate in Applied Economics; expected May 2027 — *September 2021–present*

Dissertation committee: Elton Mykerezi (chair), Aaron Sojourner, Marc F. Bellemare, and Paul Glewwe

University of Minnesota–Twin Cities — **Saint Paul, MN**
M.S. in Applied Economics — *September 2019–May 2021*

Escuela Superior Politécnica del Litoral (ESPOL) — **Guayaquil, Ecuador**
Economist, Minor in Management — *May 2012–April 2017*

WORKING PAPERS

American Indian Casino Operations and Firm Long-Run Employment and Sales *(Job Market Paper)*. **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**, Randall Akee, and Elton Mykerezi. NBER Working Paper No. 32555, 2024 (circulated under an earlier title). Examines the long-run effects of American Indian casino operations on employment and sales at adjacent firms using longitudinal firm data and a staggered-adoption research design.

Eliciting Information about Teacher Applicants Using Open-Ended Questions. **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**, Dan Goldhaber, Cyrus Grout, Elton Mykerezi, Prayash Pathak, and Aaron Sojourner.

Would Longer Weekends Keep Teachers in Rural Schools? Evidence from Minnesota's Four-Day School Week Program. **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**, Elton Mykerezi, and Janna E. Johnson. 2026. *2026 AAEA Annual Meeting paper*. AgEcon Search. doi:10.22004/AG.ECON.404607.

Type-Consistent Willingness to Pay in Contingent Valuation Methods: An Application to the Mangrove Forest in the Gulf of Guayaquil. J. G. Castillo, **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**, and I. Valverde-Bajaña. SSRN working paper (circulated under an earlier title).

WORK IN PROGRESS

Unpacking the Impact of Increased School Funding on Teacher Retention: Insights from Minnesota's Public-School Districts via Referendum Data. **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez** and Elton Mykerezi.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

The Price Premium of Heritage in the Housing Market: Evidence from Auckland, New Zealand. David Bade, Jose Gabriel Castillo, Mario Andres Fernandez, and **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**. 2020. *Land Use Policy* 99: 105042. doi:10.1016/j.landusepol.2020.105042.

Experimental Design with Network Effects for Companies to Enter in a Monopoly Market: Case Study with Undergraduate Students in an Entrepreneurial Roleplay Setting. Gonzalo Villa-Cox, Everardo Quezada, **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**, Ivanna Valverde-Bajaña, and Paul Vera-Gilces. 2018. *Cuadernos de Economía* 41(115): 130–139. doi:10.1016/j.cesjef.2017.04.003.

Relationship between Economic Growth and Environmental Degradation: Is There Evidence of an Environmental Kuznets Curve for Brazil? Manuel A. Zambrano-Monserrate, Ivanna Valverde-Bajaña, **Joseph Aguilar-Bohorquez**, and María J. Mendoza-Jiménez. 2016. *International Journal of Energy Economics and Policy* 6(2): 208–216. https://izlik.org/JA95YT78RG.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Department of Applied Economics, University of Minnesota **Saint Paul, MN**
Graduate Research Assistant *January 2022–present*

- Conduct research on American Indian economies, rural and regional development, teacher labor markets, and education policy using firm, administrative, and text data.
- Collaborate on empirical research using causal-inference methods, machine learning, text analysis, and large language model APIs.

Center for Economic Research, ESPOL **Guayaquil, Ecuador**
Research and Teaching Assistant (official title: Teaching Technician) *May 2018–May 2019*

- Conducted literature reviews and data management, contributed to grant applications, and drafted the economic background section of a quarterly economic policy bulletin.

Rector's Office and ESPAE, ESPOL **Guayaquil, Ecuador**
Manager and Research Assistant *August 2017–April 2018*

- Supported the Zona de Innovación del Litoral Ecuatoriano project, analyzed export value chains, and contributed to research on business groups and tax-evasion incentives in Ecuador.

College of Social Sciences and Humanities, ESPOL **Guayaquil, Ecuador**
Research Assistant *May 2016–March 2017*

- Supported literature reviews, data analysis, manuscript preparation, and undergraduate instruction across faculty research projects.

EXTENSION AND APPLIED POLICY PROJECTS

Business Dynamism and Economic Structure in Minnesota *2025–present*
University of Minnesota Extension; Neil Linscheid and Elton Mykerezi
Analyzed county-level YourEconomy Time Series (YTS) data and prepared an internal spatial policy brief comparing business and job starts, business entry and exit, and employment and establishment-size structure across Minnesota counties.

Cost-Benefit Analysis of Minnesota SNAP-Ed Direct Education *2026–present*
University of Minnesota Extension, Department of Family, Health and Wellbeing; Elton Mykerezi
Analyzed pre-post adult and youth outcomes using project-provided data and program cost totals, and prepared two internal reports developing the evidence base and an expected-value model linking behavioral improvements to BMI and annual medical expenditures under explicit persistence, decay, and baseline-risk assumptions.

Olivia Armory Wellness & Community Hub *2025–present*
City of Olivia and University of Minnesota Extension Southwest Regional Sustainable Development Partnership; Elton Mykerezi
Prepared an internal report synthesizing comparable cases and applied public-finance evidence, with practical guidance on willingness-to-pay surveys, public provision with user fees, and tourism and economic-impact tracking.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Humphrey School of Public Affairs, University of Minnesota **Minneapolis, MN**
Graduate Teaching Assistant, PA 8302: Applied Policy Analysis *September 2021–January 2022*

- Supported graduate instruction in econometric policy-evaluation methods and their implementation in Stata and R; instructor: Janna E. Johnson.

Center for Economic Research, ESPOL **Guayaquil, Ecuador**
Teaching Assistant, Econometrics I and II (official title: Teaching Technician) *May 2018–May 2019*

- Led weekly Stata laboratory and practice sessions for one section each of Econometrics I and Econometrics II; supervised student paper-replication projects for a second Econometrics II section; and supported assessment and course delivery across all three sections.

Instructor, Stata Statistical Software: The Basics, ESPOL *May 2019*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

American Indian Casino Operations and Firm Long-Run Employment and Sales. 20th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association, Federal Reserve Bank of Chicago, Chicago, IL, September 25–26, 2026. *Scheduled.*

American Indian Casino Operations and Firm Long-Run Employment and Sales. Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, selected presentation, Kansas City, MO, July 28, 2026. *Scheduled.*

Would Longer Weekends Keep Teachers in Rural Schools? Evidence from Minnesota's Four-Day School Week Program. Agricultural & Applied Economics Association Annual Meeting, lightning presentation, Kansas City, MO, July 28, 2026. *Scheduled.*

American Indian Casino Operations and Firm Long-Run Employment and Sales. Counterfactual Methods for Policy Impact Evaluation (COMPIE), European Commission's Competence Centre on Microeconomic Evaluation (CC-ME) in collaboration with IÉSEG School of Management, Paris, France, June 24–26, 2026.

The Price Premium of Heritage in the Housing Market: Evidence from Auckland, New Zealand. VI International Congress of Economy, Universidad San Francisco de Quito, Quito, Ecuador, July 2018.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Willard W. Cochrane Fellowship, University of Minnesota *2021–2022*

Fulbright Scholarship for the M.S. in Applied Economics, University of Minnesota; selected through a national competition in Ecuador *2019–2021*

DAAD Study Visit Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service *2016*

Best Economics Student Award, College of Social Sciences and Humanities, ESPOL *2016*

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Ph.D. Student Representative, Applied Economics Graduate Program Committee, University of Minnesota *2022–2024*

Student Representative, Board of Directors, College of Social Sciences and Humanities, ESPOL *2015–2016*

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Statistical software and programming: Stata, Python, R
GIS and mapping: ArcGIS Pro (county-level thematic mapping and spatial visualization)
Document preparation: LaTeX
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Elton Mykerezi
Professor, Department of Applied Economics
Extension Economist, University of Minnesota Extension
University of Minnesota
myker001@umn.edu

Randall Akee
Julie Johnson Kidd Professor of Indigenous Governance and Development
Director, Project on Indigenous Governance and Development
Harvard Kennedy School, Harvard University
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Aaron Sojourner
Senior Economist and Deputy Director of Research
W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research
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